

WELCOME TO THE DISCWORLD

A quick primer for players new to Terry Pratchett's world

TONE: dry, sarcastic, full of puns. Common sense is rare, so be polite to anyone carrying an axe, and never ask what's in the sausage.

THE DISC

A flat world, balanced on the backs of **four elephants**, who stand on the shell of a giant turtle (**Great A'Tuin**) swimming through space. Everyone here thinks this is perfectly normal. It's fantasy, but with the clichés poked until they squeak.

- **Narrative Causality:** stories *want* to happen. One-in-a-million chances come up nine times out of ten, and the funnier or more dramatic option usually wins. Lean in.
- **Magic is real and can do anything, but should it?** If it results in something interesting it will probably cooperate, but never without some sort of mishap. Clever wizards quickly learn to use it only in times of need.
- **Directions:** there's no north or south. Travel is **hubwards** (toward the Disc's centre), **rimwards** (toward the edge), **turnwise** (with the Disc's spin) or **widdershins** (against it).
- **Belief is power.** Gods, ideas and monsters exist because enough people believe in them.

ANKH-MORPORK

The biggest, smelliest, most cosmopolitan city on the Disc, and the home of nearly everyone you'll play. Sits on the **River Ankh**, so polluted it's crunchy, and you can almost walk across. Every species lives here, and gets along because everyone is equally mistrusted.

- **Lord Vetinari, the Patrician**, rules the city: a thin, calm, terrifying tyrant who is both feared *and* respected, and who somehow keeps the whole mess running. You do not want him to take an interest in you.
- **The Guilds run everything.** Rather than fight crime, the city regulates it:
 - **Thieves:** licensed, with a yearly quota. Pay your dues and you get a receipt, and nobody else will rob you.
 - **Assassins:** gentlemen and ladies of taste, with a dress code and rules of engagement. Murder is a profession like any other.
 - **Beggars:** licensed pitches and a strict pecking order. Don't even *think* of poaching a corner.
 - **Fools:** clowns and jesters, professionally trained. Funnier than they look, and pies are serious business.
 - **Seamstresses:** not to be confused with "needlewomen" (those who actually mend textiles). The guild instead provides ladies of negotiable affection.
- **The City Watch** is run by **Commander Vimes** and recruits from every species in the city. The members range from sharp to sleepy, and they're underfunded and rarely taken seriously (except by the criminals).
- **Unseen University** is where the wizards live, eat enormous meals, and are carefully ignored. The Librarian is an orangutan.

YOU ARE A HUMAN

- **What you are:** the most common species on the Disc. If there's land, humans have made a mess of it. In fact, there's a 99% chance that the person reading this handout right now is a human.
- **Strengths:** adaptability and a talent for survival. You're not stronger than a troll or as sturdy as a dwarf, but are you more clever than a vampire? Also no, but at least you're still alive and kickin', and that has to be worth something.
- **Morporkians:** practical, cynical, assume everyone's out for themselves, and are right about half the time. They love a bargain, a complaint, and a pie in the street, even when they're not sure what it's made of.
- **From elsewhere:** humans live all over the Disc. **Überwald** is fictional Transylvania (nobles have a *von* in their name), **Klatch** is a vast desert region (think the historic Ottoman or Arabic empires), **Ephebe** is a coastal city-state like ancient Greece (philosophers and such), and **Quirm** is basically France.
- **Stereotypes:** See "From elsewhere".
- **Names:** plain (Sam, Fred, Rosie, Trevor), posh (Havelock, Sybil, Mustrum) or evocative (Cut-Me-Own-Throat Dibbler).



Drawn by Paul Kidby.